

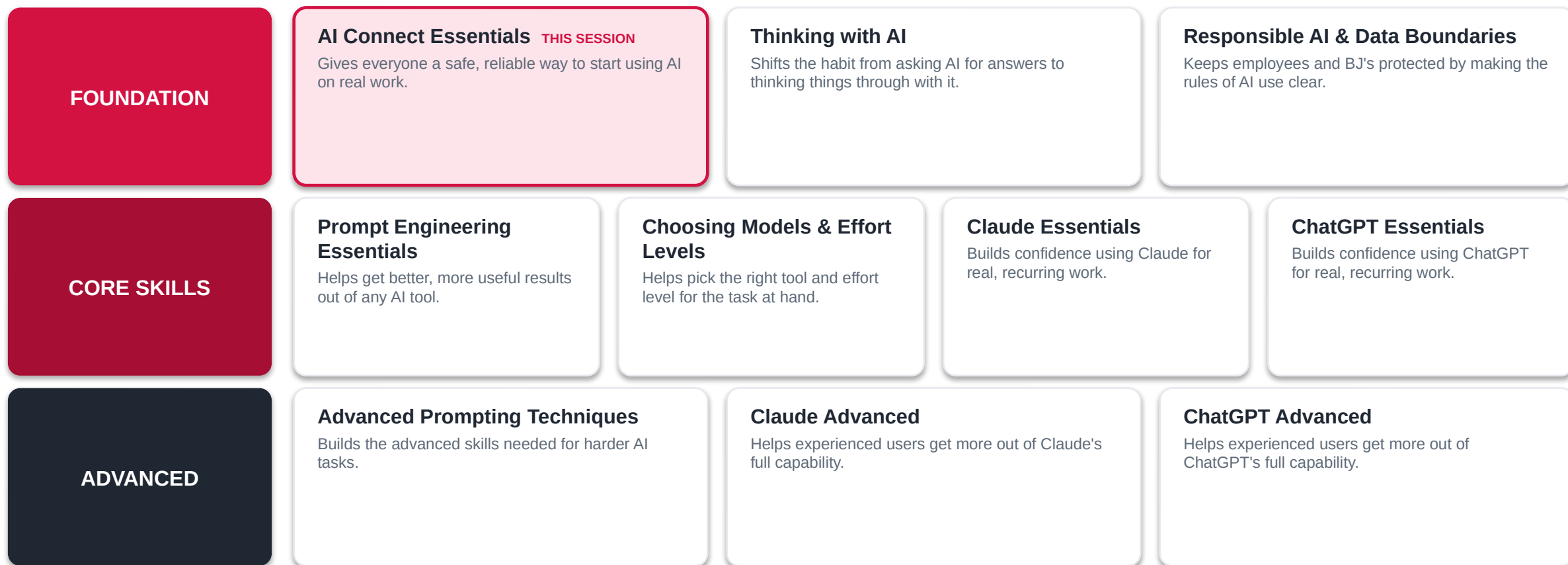
AI Connect Essentials

Use AI effectively, responsibly, and economically on real BJ's work

July 2026

Training Roadmap

Course offerings mapped to each stage of the AI Learning Framework. This session is the starting point.



Set up Claude before your first task

Four settings that make Claude work like it already knows you. Set them once.

1 Introduce yourself

Settings → Profile

Your name, what you do, and how you like responses. Claude carries it into every chat.

[Screenshot: Settings → Profile]

2 Check memory is on

Settings → Memory

Two toggles, on by default: “Search and reference chats” and “Generate memory from chats.” This is also where you edit what Claude remembers.

[Screenshot: Settings → Memory]

3 Set your style

In chat: Search and tools → Use style

Normal, Concise, Formal, or Explanatory. Or create a custom style from a sample of your own writing.

[Screenshot: style picker]

4 Know the model picker

In the chat input

Model and effort level, right where you type. How to choose them well is covered later in this session.

[Screenshot: model & effort picker]

This takes five minutes, once. **Every chat you run after today benefits from it.**

What you should be able to do after this session

By the end of this session, you'll run any AI task through the same three steps — in order.



STEP 1

Select the problem

Identify which tasks AI can help with, and decide what a good result looks like before you start.



STEP 2

Guide the AI

Provide clear direction and context, then review and improve the first response before you use it.



STEP 3

Own the results

Review the work for accuracy, gaps, and risk, and stay accountable for how it is used.

The goal is not to become an AI expert in one hour. **It's to leave with a safe, practical way to start using AI on real work.**

Is AI the right choice for this task?

Run any task through this test before you open the tool.

THE TASK-FIT TEST

1

Information-based

Writing, summarizing, comparing, organizing, analyzing, or planning.

2

Repeatable

Happens regularly or follows a recognizable pattern.

3

Reviewable

You have enough expertise to judge whether the result is useful.

4

High-volume or time-consuming

Requires significant manual effort, occurs frequently, or must be done at scale.

TASK

"Summarize this week's member survey comments into themes."

- ✓ **Information-based:** comments are text to synthesize
- ✓ **Repeatable:** member surveys come in every week
- ✓ **Reviewable:** you know the club and can judge the themes
- ✓ **High-volume:** 25+ open-text comments to work through by hand

✓ **Passes all four. Good candidate for AI.**

Not every task deserves AI. **Filter first, then engage the tool.**

Where AI can help

Once a task passes the test, these are common places to start.



SUMMARIZE

Turn long meeting notes into decisions, owners, and next steps.



COMPARE

Compare two vendor proposals across cost, risk, and timeline.



DRAFT

Draft a first version of this week's leadership update.



ANALYZE

Spot the pattern behind rising checkout wait times.



PREPARE

Build talking points for an upcoming club or vendor visit.



BRAINSTORM

Explore ideas to improve the in-club member experience.



CHALLENGE

Find the weak points in a plan before it goes to leadership.



SIMPLIFY

Rewrite a dense policy into plain guidance for club teams.

You don't need all eight patterns for one task. **Pick the one that fits, and start there.**

Thinking with AI, not just asking AI

This shift matters most in research, exploration, and one-off work, when the problem isn't defined yet.

FROM

"Explain why membership renewals dipped this quarter."

- Has to guess at what actually matters
- May miss the real driver
- Often needs heavy cleanup

TO

"I'm trying to understand why renewals dipped. Walk me through the possible drivers before you land on one."

- ✓ Clarifies the problem first
- ✓ Explores more than one driver
- ✓ Challenges assumptions before landing on an answer

If the task is routine and clear, a quick prompt is fine. **If the problem isn't defined yet, use this shift first.**

When direction is missing, AI has to decide what matters

Same task, two different levels of direction. One leaves AI guessing.

WEAK

"Summarize this member feedback."

AI OUTPUT

Members shared feedback about checkout lines, coupons, and service.
Mostly general comments, with no clear priority or next step.

STRONG

"You have 25 member comments from last week's club survey below. Identify the three most frequently mentioned issues and recommend two practical next steps. Write it as a short, scannable briefing, a one-line headline followed by bullets. Keep the tone factual and neutral, with no hype. It's for a regional operations leader skimming between meetings. Keep it under 150 words, and don't infer causes the comments don't support."

AI OUTPUT

Checkout wait times are this week's top member concern.

- Weekend checkout wait times: 9 of 25 comments
- Coupons not loading or applying: 6 comments
- Popular items out of stock later in the day: 5 comments

Next: review weekend checkout coverage and look into the coupon issue before assuming a cause.

Same task, same AI. **The direction made the difference.**

CO-STAR: a practical checklist for a strong prompt

The same strong prompt from the last slide, broken into its six CO-STAR parts. Each one removes another piece of guesswork for the AI.

C	Context Relevant background and source information.	<i>You have 25 member comments from last week's club survey below.</i>
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O	Objective What you want it to accomplish.	<i>Identify the three most frequently mentioned issues and recommend two practical next steps.</i>
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S	Style How it should be written or presented.	<i>Write it as a short, scannable briefing, a one-line headline followed by bullets.</i>
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T	Tone The voice it should use.	<i>Keep the tone factual and neutral, with no hype.</i>
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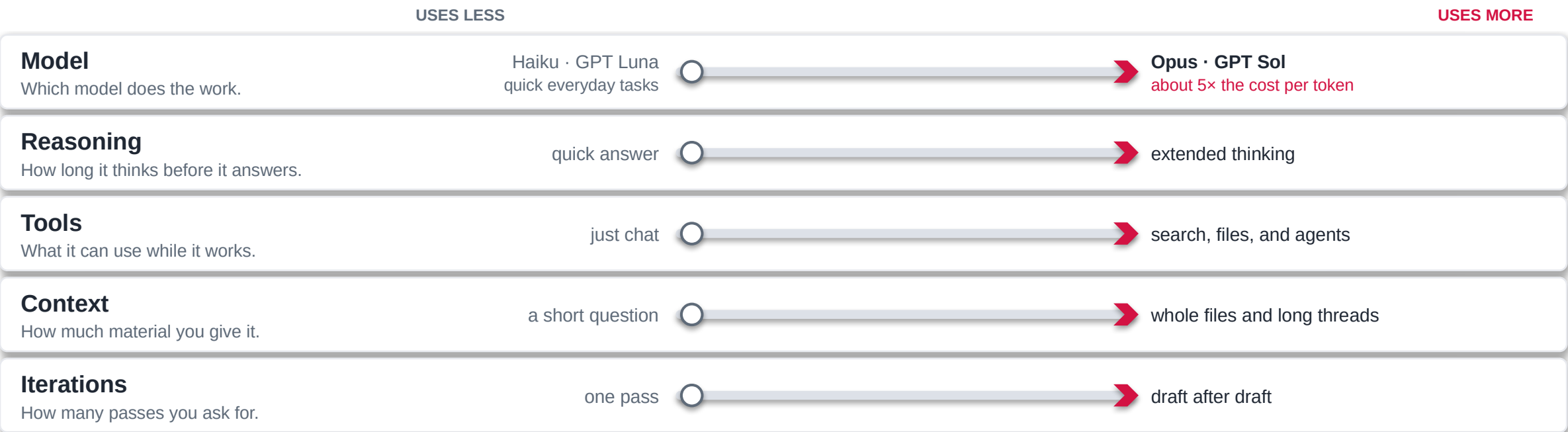
A	Audience Who will read or use the output.	<i>It's for a regional operations leader skimming between meetings.</i>
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R	Response The exact output structure you need.	<i>Keep it under 150 words, and don't infer causes the comments don't support.</i>
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Not every prompt needs every element. **Use the ones that reduce ambiguity.**

AI usage is not one setting

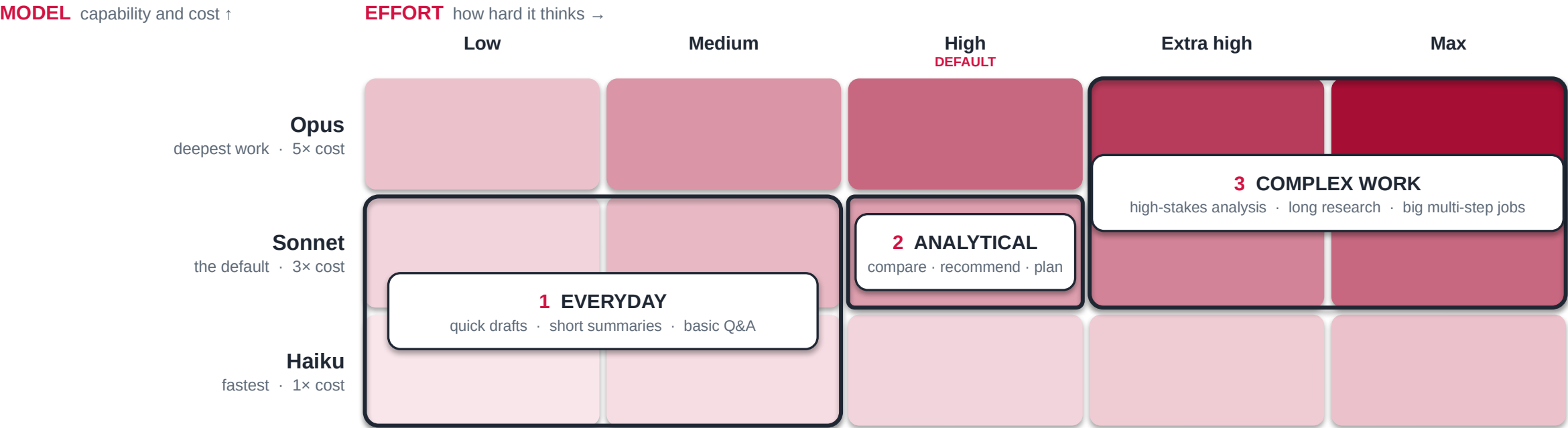
Every AI task runs on five dials you control. Each one you turn up adds capability, and adds usage.



Match the dials to the task. **Turn them up only when the task earns it.**

Start efficient, then escalate deliberately

Every Claude task is one cell on this map: a model times an effort level. Cost climbs toward the top right.



Start in the everyday zone. **Move up only when quality, complexity, or tool needs earn the added usage.**

Give AI the right data, and only what it needs

Not sure whether something can go into an AI tool? Check its color first.

 GREEN generally OK

- Public information
- Published BJ's materials
- Generic process questions
- Drafting, editing, brainstorming
- Job descriptions and role profiles
- Aggregated or anonymized data
- General market research

Use freely in approved tools.

 YELLOW proceed carefully

- Internal strategy documents and project plans
- Internal emails
- Sales, inventory, or transaction trends
- Vendor or supplier information
- Non-public financials or merchandising
- Competitive research
- Anything uncomfortable if seen out of context

Share the minimum the task needs.

 RED only with written approval

- Member PII or identifiable purchase history
- Credit card (PCI) or health (HIPAA) data
- HR records: pay, leave, health, discipline
- Material non-public information
- Passwords and encryption keys
- M&A, litigation, trade secrets
- Anything marked Restricted Confidential

Never without explicit written authorization.

GIVE ENOUGH, NOT EVERYTHING an excerpt beats the whole document · strip names and IDs the task doesn't need · when unsure, stop and ask

If it's green, go. If it's yellow, trim it down. **If it's red, stop.**

Connectors, approvals, and when to pause

A connector gives AI access to another system, like email or files. Granting one is a data decision, not a convenience.

APPROVED CONNECTORS

[Placeholder: list of BJ's-approved connectors goes here. Sudeep to confirm with IT.]

REQUESTING A NEW CONNECTOR

[Placeholder: request and approval process. Sudeep to confirm with IT.]

PAUSE AND ASK FOR HELP WHEN...

- You're not sure the data is permitted
- You're asking AI to take action or connect to another system
- The output affects employees, members, vendors, money, or compliance
- You can't independently check whether the result is right

When in doubt, **stop before adding more context or enabling more access.**

You own the final work

AI can assist, but it does not transfer accountability.

1 Information provided

You choose what context, data, and files are appropriate to enter.

2 Validation performed

You check facts, logic, completeness, and risk before use.

3 Judgment applied

You decide what to accept, modify, reject, or escalate.

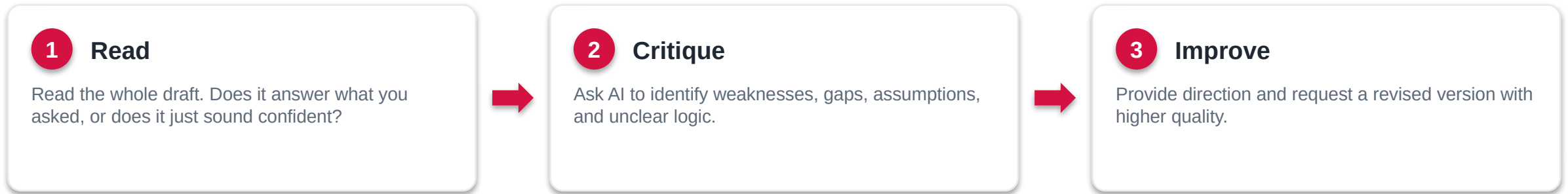
4 Action taken

You own anything sent, shared, submitted, or acted upon.

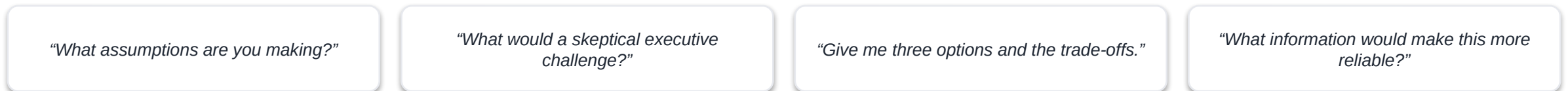
AI informs and assists. **BJ's team members decide and act.**

Treat the first response as a draft

The value often comes from the follow-up.



HIGH-VALUE FOLLOW-UPS



Do not accept the first answer just because it sounds polished.

Check before you use the output

AI-generated work needs human review before it is shared or acted upon.

FACTS

Are names, dates, figures, claims, and source references correct?

FIT

Does it fit the audience, purpose, tone, and BJ's context?

GAPS

What is missing, assumed, overgeneralized, or unsupported?

RISK

Could this create legal, financial, workforce, member, security, or reputational risk?

REVIEW QUESTION **“Would I be comfortable putting my name on this and explaining how I validated it?”**

Warning signs in AI-generated content

Polished does not mean correct. These three signs break your trust in the content.

Invented facts

Specific claims, citations, or examples that were not provided or cannot be verified.

EXAMPLE

Cites an "industry benchmark" or a vendor statistic that never appeared in your source material and can't be traced back to anything real.

Unsupported conclusions

Reasoning jumps from limited evidence to a strong recommendation.

EXAMPLE

Three comments mention slow checkout, and the recommendation is to overhaul the entire POS system. The fix is far bigger than the evidence supports.

False confidence

No uncertainty even when the information is incomplete.

EXAMPLE

States a rollout date as fact when your prompt only gave a rough estimate. No "likely," no flagged assumption, no hedge at all.

Confident writing is not evidence. **Ask what the output actually supports before you believe it.**

Warning signs in AI-generated content

The subtler signs: work that sounds right but is wrong in the details.

Wrong numbers

Calculation errors, mismatched totals, or changed units.

EXAMPLE

The category breakdown lists percentages that add up to 94%, or quotes a cost per unit in one paragraph and per case in the next.

Missing nuance

Important exceptions, trade-offs, or stakeholder concerns are absent.

EXAMPLE

A staffing recommendation assumes unlimited overtime budget, ignoring the labor-hour constraint you mentioned two messages earlier.

Wrong tone

Content sounds too casual, too formal, insensitive, or off-brand.

EXAMPLE

A note to club team members about a policy change reads like a legal disclaimer. Accurate, but nothing a manager would ever say out loud.

When you see a warning sign, do not just edit around it. **Diagnose what context, verification, or human judgment is missing.**